

Paid Time Off (PTO) Policy – California Employees

1. Purpose

This Paid Time Off (PTO) Policy establishes guidelines for paid leave benefits that support employee wellbeing, work-life balance, workforce planning, and compliance with California employment laws. The Company recognizes that time away from work is important for physical health, mental wellness, family responsibilities, personal development, and overall employee engagement. The purpose of this policy is to provide employees with a clear understanding of PTO eligibility, accruals, usage, approval procedures, carryover provisions, and related leave benefits.

Employees and managers share responsibility for ensuring effective administration of PTO benefits. Consistent application of PTO practices helps support employee wellbeing, operational continuity, fairness, and legal compliance.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all California-based employees. The Company operates primarily on-site in San Diego, California, with approved hybrid work arrangements available. This policy governs PTO benefits for eligible employees and should be read in conjunction with applicable leave policies, employee handbook provisions, and state and federal leave requirements.

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3. Policy Philosophy

The Company believes employees perform at their best when they have opportunities to rest, recharge, address personal responsibilities, and maintain healthy work-life integration. PTO benefits are intended to provide flexibility while ensuring business continuity and operational effectiveness. Employees are encouraged to use available PTO responsibly throughout the year.

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4. Eligibility

Full-time employees are eligible to accrue PTO beginning on their first day of employment. Part-time employees are also eligible to accrue PTO, but at a lower accrual rate that reflects

their scheduled work hours. Temporary employees, interns, and contractors generally are not eligible unless specifically authorized by Company policy or contractual agreement.

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5. Full-Time Employee Accrual

Full-time employees accrue PTO at a rate equivalent to approximately twenty days annually. PTO accrual begins on the first day of employment and continues during active employment in accordance with payroll practices and Company guidelines. Accrual balances are maintained through the Company's payroll or human resources systems.

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6. Part-Time Employee Accrual

Part-time employees accrue PTO on a proportional basis according to regularly scheduled work hours. The Company seeks to provide equitable leave benefits while recognizing differences in scheduled work time. PTO balances and accrual information will be reflected in Company systems.

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7. PTO Accrual Administration

Accruals are calculated according to established payroll practices. Employees are responsible for reviewing PTO balances regularly and reporting any discrepancies promptly. Human Resources and Payroll maintain official PTO records.

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8. Permitted Uses of PTO

PTO may be used for vacation, personal time, illness, medical appointments, mental health and wellness, family care responsibilities, school activities, personal obligations, rest and recovery, religious observances, and other approved purposes. Employees are encouraged to schedule planned absences in advance whenever possible.

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9. Vacation Planning

The Company encourages employees to utilize PTO for vacations and personal renewal. Advance planning helps ensure adequate staffing levels and minimizes disruption to business operations. Employees should coordinate anticipated vacations with their managers and coworkers.

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10. Personal Time and Wellness

The Company recognizes the importance of personal wellbeing. Employees may use PTO to support mental health, stress management, family responsibilities, personal development activities, or other circumstances that contribute to overall wellness.

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11. Sick Leave Compliance

The Company complies with the California Healthy Workplaces, Healthy Families Act and applicable local requirements. PTO benefits are designed to meet or exceed minimum legal requirements where applicable. Employees should consult Human Resources regarding questions related to paid sick leave rights and protections.

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12. Company Holidays

The Company observes designated paid holidays including New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Jr. Day, Memorial Day, Juneteenth, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving Day, the Day after Thanksgiving, Christmas Eve, and Christmas Day. Additional floating holidays may be announced periodically.

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13. Requesting PTO

Employees should submit PTO requests through the designated HR or payroll system. Whenever possible, requests should be submitted at least two weeks in advance for vacations exceeding three business days and at least thirty days in advance for extended absences. Managers may approve exceptions when circumstances warrant.

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14. PTO Approval Process

PTO approval depends on staffing levels, operational requirements, customer commitments, project schedules, and business needs. Managers strive to approve requests whenever possible while balancing organizational priorities. Approval decisions are made fairly and consistently.

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15. Peak Business Periods

Certain departments may experience peak business periods during which PTO requests are subject to additional review. Managers should communicate anticipated blackout periods or staffing constraints in advance whenever practical.

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16. Coverage Expectations

Employees are expected to coordinate work coverage prior to planned absences. Responsibilities may include updating project documentation, delegating tasks, setting out-of-office messages, and informing relevant stakeholders of planned unavailability.

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17. PTO Usage Guidelines

Employees may generally use accrued PTO as it becomes available, subject to manager approval and business needs. Employees should not assume PTO requests are approved until confirmation is received through the appropriate process.

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18. PTO Carryover

Unused accrued PTO may carry over from year to year in accordance with California law. The Company may establish a reasonable accrual cap consistent with legal requirements. Employees are encouraged to use PTO regularly and avoid excessive balance accumulation.

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19. Accrual Caps

To encourage work-life balance and support workforce planning, the Company may implement an accrual cap. Once an employee reaches the maximum allowable balance, additional accruals may temporarily cease until PTO is used and the balance falls below the cap.

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20. Separation of Employment

Upon separation of employment, accrued and unused PTO will be paid out in accordance with California law. Final PTO payout calculations will be based on official payroll and human resources records.

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21. Leaves of Absence

Employees may qualify for protected leave under the California Family Rights Act (CFRA), Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA), Pregnancy Disability Leave (PDL), military leave laws, jury duty obligations, voting leave requirements, and other applicable laws. PTO may interact with these leave programs in certain circumstances.

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22. Bereavement Leave

Employees may be eligible for bereavement leave in accordance with applicable Company policy and California law. Employees should contact Human Resources for guidance regarding available benefits and procedures.

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23. Jury Duty and Civic Responsibilities

The Company supports employee participation in civic responsibilities including jury service and voting. Employees should notify management promptly when receiving jury duty summonses or anticipating time away for legally protected civic obligations.

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24. Manager Responsibilities

Managers are responsible for reviewing requests, maintaining fairness, planning staffing levels, supporting employee wellbeing, communicating expectations, and ensuring compliance with policy requirements. Managers should encourage employees to take appropriate time off throughout the year.

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25. Human Resources Responsibilities

Human Resources is responsible for policy administration, compliance oversight, employee guidance, recordkeeping support, and interpretation of PTO requirements. Human Resources also provides assistance regarding leave laws and employee rights.

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26. Misuse of PTO

Providing false information, misrepresenting the purpose of leave, or abusing PTO benefits may result in corrective action. The Company reserves the right to investigate suspected misuse while respecting employee privacy rights.

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27. Frequently Asked Questions

Employees should contact Human Resources whenever questions arise regarding PTO accruals, balances, approvals, carryover provisions, payout calculations, protected leave rights, or policy interpretation.

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28. Policy Administration

The Company reserves the right to revise, modify, suspend, or discontinue this policy at any time, subject to applicable law. Nothing in this policy creates a contract of employment or alters the at-will employment relationship.

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Appendix 1: PTO Best Practices

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